

DEVELOPING THE NEXT GENERATION OF AFRICAN LEADERS

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Nelson Mandela once reminded us that: "We must take responsibility for the future, for shaping a world that is more humane, more just, more compassionate. We must reach across the divisions that history has created among us – and build bridges, not walls."

As the African continent navigates an increasingly multipolar world, we need leaders who can build those bridges across nations, languages, disciplines, and generations. We need leadership that is courageous, inclusive, and deeply anchored in integrity. And critically, we need to build leadership pipelines that prepare young Africans not merely to inherit broken systems, but to transform them into more just and equitable ones.

Defining next-generation leadership

The leaders Africa needs for the decades ahead must embody four key qualities: integrity, innovation, resilience, and a global outlook. Integrity gives leadership its moral centre. Innovation equips leaders to solve complex challenges in creative ways. Resilience allows them to remain anchored in their purpose through uncertainty. And a global outlook enables African leaders to operate confidently on the world stage while staying grounded in their local contexts.

Next-generation leadership in Africa must therefore be rooted in integrity, courage, and inclusion, values that do not simply guide decision-making but define the very character of our societies.

Education and leadership development

Education alone does not create transformative leaders. Africa's diversity is its greatest strength, but it also brings deep complexity. The kind of education that truly shapes visionary leadership cultivates both intellectual capacity and emotional intelligence, where technical skill meets ethical reflection.

When we integrate critical thinking, cross-cultural learning, and value-based decision-making into education, we produce leaders capable of navigating complex moral, political, and economic realities.